

PROBLEM OF EVIL

FORMS OF EVIL → LOGICAL PROBLEM AND DEFENCE → SOUL-MAKING AND NATURAL ORDER → LEIBNIZ, AUGUSTINE AND PROCESS → EVIDENTIAL EVIL → INDIAN RESPONSE MATRIX

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g13 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 FORMS OF EVIL

FORMS OF EVIL FREELY CAUSED CRUELTY, OPPRESSION, BETRAYAL DISEASE, EARTHQUAKE, CONGENITAL SUFFERING SUFFERING THAT THREATENS LIFE'S OVERALL MEANING PAIN PREDATING HUMAN AGENCY PROBLEM TYPES LOGICAL GOD AND EVIL ARE STRICTLY INCONSISTENT EVIDENTIAL AMOUNT/KINDS OF EVIL MAKE GOD IMPROBABLE EXISTENTIAL

moral: freely caused cruelty, oppression, betrayal

natural: disease, earthquake, congenital suffering

horrendous: suffering that threatens life's overall meaning

animal/evolutionary: pain predating human agency

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- moral: freely caused cruelty, oppression, betrayal
- natural: disease, earthquake, congenital suffering

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- horrendous: suffering that threatens life's overall meaning
- animal/evolutionary: pain predating human agency

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- PROBLEM TYPES logical: God and evil are strictly inconsistent evidential: amount/kinds of evil make God improbable existential: suffering
- disrupts trust, worship and meaning.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: High-value transition: Animal suffering is a central evidential challenge because predation, disease, parasitism and extinction precede human agency and often seem unrelated to moral growth.

01

STAGE 01 LOGICAL PROBLEM AND DEFENCE

LOGICAL PROBLEM AND DEFENCE CLAIMED SET OMNIPOTENT GOD + OMNISCIENT GOD + PERFECTLY GOOD GOD A GOOD, POWERFUL BEING ELIMINATES EVERY EVIL IT CAN PLANTINGA FREE-WILL DEFENCE SIGNIFICANT FREEDOM POSSIBILITY OF MORAL WRONG GOD CANNOT CAUSE A CREATURE TO CHOOSE FREELY AND COMPATIBILITY IS DEFENDED; ACTUAL QUANTITY OF EVIL IS NOT

CLAIMED SET: omnipotent God + omniscient God + perfectly good God + evil exists missing

PLANTINGA FREE-WILL DEFENCE significant freedom → possibility of moral wrong

God cannot cause a creature to choose freely and guarantee only right choices transworld depravity

RESULT: compatibility is defended; actual quantity of evil is not thereby explained.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- CLAIMED SET: omnipotent God + omniscient God + perfectly good God + evil exists missing premise: a good, powerful being eliminates every evil it can
- PLANTINGA FREE-WILL DEFENCE significant freedom → possibility of moral wrong

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- God cannot cause a creature to choose freely and guarantee only right choices transworld depravity shows logical possibility of unavoidable misuse
- RESULT: compatibility is defended; actual quantity of evil is not thereby explained.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- CLAIMED SET: omnipotent God + omniscient God + perfectly good God + evil exists missing premise: a good, powerful being eliminates every evil it can
- PLANTINGA FREE-WILL DEFENCE significant freedom → possibility of moral wrong

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RESULT: compatibility is defended; actual quantity of evil is not thereby explained.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Free-will defence establishes possible compatibility between God and moral evil, not a complete explanation of actual suffering.

02

STAGE 02 SOUL-MAKING AND NATURAL ORDER

SOUL-MAKING AND NATURAL ORDER JOHN HICK EPISTEMIC DISTANCE + STABLE NATURAL LAWS + GENUINE AGENCY STRUGGLE COURAGE, COMPASSION, RESPONSIBILITY PERSON-MAKING STRENGTH ADDRESSES WHY A READY-MADE PARADISE MAY DEFEAT MATURE FREEDOM VICTIMS USED AS MEANS: SUFFERING IS EXCESSIVE AND UNEVEN INFANTS, ANIMALS AND HORRORS DO NOT RELIABLY IMPROVE SUFFERERS

IRENAEUS / JOHN HICK epistemic distance + stable natural laws + risk → genuine agency

suffering is excessive and uneven

infants, animals and horrors do not reliably improve sufferers reply requires afterlife fulfilment/universal restoration, which

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- IRENAEUS / JOHN HICK epistemic distance + stable natural laws + risk → genuine agency struggle → courage,
- suffering is excessive and uneven

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- infants, animals and horrors do not reliably improve sufferers reply requires afterlife fulfilment/universal restoration, which adds further commitments.
- IRENAEUS / JOHN HICK epistemic distance + stable natural laws + risk → genuine agency struggle → courage,

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- suffering is excessive and uneven
- infants, animals and horrors do not reliably improve sufferers reply requires afterlife fulfilment/universal restoration, which adds further commitments.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Soul-making gains moral depth from stable natural order, but it risks treating victims' suffering as an instrument for others' development.

03

STAGE 03 LEIBNIZ, AUGUSTINE AND PROCESS REVISIONS

LEIBNIZ, AUGUSTINE AND PROCESS REVISIONS EVIL IS PRIVATIO BONI, NOT A CREATED SUBSTANCE; MISUSE BEST POSSIBLE WORLD BALANCES LAWS, FREEDOM AND TOTAL COMPOSSIBILITY GOD MAY PERMIT EVIL FOR A GREATER GOOD, NEVER PROCESS THEISM GOD PERSUADES BUT CANNOT UNILATERALLY PREVENT EVERY EVENT PRIVATION DOES NOT LESSEN FELT HORROR; "BEST" CAN SEEM GREATER-GOOD REASONING RISKS INSTRUMENTALISING VICTIMS; PROCESS VIEW REVISES OMNIPOTENCE.

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
AUGUSTINE: evil is privatio boni, not a created substance; misuse of freedom disorders good LEIBNIZ: best possible world balances laws, freedom and total compossibility	AQUINAS: God may permit evil for a greater good, never will evil as evil PROCESS THEISM: God persuades but cannot unilaterally prevent every event	COSTS: privation does not lessen felt horror; "best" can seem complacent greater-good reasoning risks instrumentalising victims; process view revises omnipotence.
SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
AUGUSTINE: evil is privatio boni, not a created substance; misuse of freedom disorders good LEIBNIZ: best possible world balances laws, freedom and total compossibility	AQUINAS: God may permit evil for a greater good, never will evil as evil PROCESS THEISM: God persuades but cannot unilaterally prevent every event	EVALUATION / TRAP COSTS: privation does not lessen felt horror; "best" can seem complacent greater-good reasoning risks instrumentalising victims; process view revises omnipotence.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Augustine denies evil positive substance, while process revisions reduce divine control; each response resolves one pressure by accepting another cost.

04

STAGE 04 EVIDENTIAL EVIL

EVIDENTIAL EVIL APPARENTLY POINTLESS SUFFERING EXISTS; AN OMNIPOTENT GOOD GOD WOULD THEREFORE GOD'S EXISTENCE IS IMPROBABLE HIDDEN FAWN CASE TESTS SKEPTICAL THEISM LIMITED HUMAN COGNITION CANNOT INFER "NO REASON" FROM "NO ABSENCE OF EVIDENCE IS EVIDENCE ONLY WHERE DETECTION SHOULD TOO MUCH SCEPTICISM ALSO WEAKENS PROVIDENTIAL AND MORAL REASONING

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- ROWE: apparently pointless suffering exists; an omnipotent good God would prevent it
- therefore God's existence is improbable hidden fawn case tests gratuitous natural suffering without human freedom

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- SKEPTICAL THEISM: limited human cognition cannot infer "no reason" from "no reason seen"
- CORNEA: absence of evidence is evidence only where detection should be expected objection: too much scepticism also weakens

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- providential and moral reasoning verdict must weigh epistemic humility against the specificity of apparently gratuitous evil.
- ROWE: apparently pointless suffering exists; an omnipotent good God would prevent it

MECHANISM / VERDICT — CORNEA: absence of evidence is evidence only where detection should be expected objection: too much scepticism also weakens providential and moral reasoning verdict must weigh epistemic humility against the specificity of apparently gratuitous evil.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: absence of evidence is evidence only where detection should be expected objection: too much scepticism also weakens providential and moral reasoning verdict must weigh epistemic humility against the specificity of apparently gratuitous evil.

05

STAGE 05 INDIAN RESPONSE MATRIX

INDIAN RESPONSE MATRIX SUFFERING BELONGS TO VYAVAHĀRIKA AVIDYĀ; ULTIMATE BRAHMAN IS NON-DUAL REAL SOULS/WORLD, KARMA, GRACE AND PURPOSEFUL DIVINE ORDER BEGINNINGLESS KARMA ALLOCATED BY ĪŚVARA; GOD IS NOT ARBITRARY KARMIC MATTER BINDS JĪVA: NO CREATOR BEARS RESPONSIBILITY DUHKHA FROM DEPENDENT ORIGATION, CRAVING AND IGNORANCE; NO CREATOR KARMA EXPLAINS MORAL CONTINUITY BUT FACES FIRST-ORIGIN, VICTIM-BLAMING AND LIBERATION ROUTES ANSWER SUFFERING THERAPEUTICALLY, NOT ALWAYS AS A

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
ADVAITA: suffering belongs to vyāvahārika avidyā; ultimate Brahman is non-dual VIŚIṢṬĀDVAITA: real souls/world, karma, grace and purposeful divine order NĪYĀYA: beginningless karma allocated by īśvara; God is not arbitrary author of deserts	JAINA: karmic matter binds jīva; no creator bears responsibility BUDDHISM: duhkha from dependent origination, craving and ignorance; no creator problem KARMA explains moral continuity but faces first-origin, victim-blaming and natural-evil pressures	liberation routes answer suffering therapeutically, not always as a theodicy.
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ADVAITA: suffering belongs to vyāvahārika avidyā; ultimate Brahman is non-dual VIŚIṢṬĀDVAITA: real souls/world, karma, grace and purposeful divine order NĪYĀYA: beginningless karma allocated by īśvara; God is not arbitrary author of deserts	JAINA: karmic matter binds jīva; no creator bears responsibility BUDDHISM: duhkha from dependent origination, craving and ignorance; no creator problem KARMA explains moral continuity but faces first-origin, victim-blaming and natural-evil pressures	EVALUATION / TRAP liberation routes answer suffering therapeutically, not always as a theodicy.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Indian traditions reshape the evil problem because they disagree about creator, self, karma and the ultimate meaning of liberation.

06

STAGE 06 HARD CASES AND ETHICAL LIMITS

HARD CASES AND ETHICAL LIMITS TEST ANY THEODICY AGAINST CHILD SUFFERING ANIMAL PAIN UNEQUAL OPPORTUNITY DOES RESPONSE EXPLAIN, MERELY DEFEND LOGICAL POSSIBILITY, OR OFFER DOES IT PRESERVE VICTIM DIGNITY? DOES IT MAKE PREVENTABLE ANTI-THEODICY WARNING NEAT JUSTIFICATION CAN REPEAT HARM REPLY

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
TEST ANY THEODICY AGAINST child suffering animal pain unequal opportunity	ASK: does response explain, merely defend logical possibility, or offer pastoral meaning? does it preserve victim dignity? does it make preventable evil morally acceptable? anti-theodicy warning: neat justification can repeat harm reply: philosophical explanation need not command passive acceptance	moral protest may itself express commitment to goodness.
SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
TEST ANY THEODICY AGAINST child suffering animal pain unequal opportunity	ASK: does response explain, merely defend logical possibility, or offer pastoral meaning? does it preserve victim dignity? does it make preventable evil morally acceptable? anti-theodicy warning: neat justification can repeat harm reply: philosophical explanation need not command passive acceptance	EVALUATION / TRAP moral protest may itself express commitment to goodness.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A sound evaluation separates logical from evidential evil, defence from theodicy, and causal explanation from moral justification.

07

STAGE 07 PYQ AND ANSWER SYNTHESIS

PYQ AND ANSWER SYNTHESIS DEFINE GOD-CONCEPT + EVIL TYPE SEPARATE LOGICAL/EVIDENTIAL/EXISTENTIAL DEMAND FORMAL ARGUMENT STRONGEST DEFENCE/THEODICY HARD-CASE OBJECTION INDIAN COMPARISON ON KARMA/DUHKHA 10 MARKS

DEFINE God-concept + evil type → separate logical/evidential/existential demand

formal argument → strongest defence/theodicy → hard-case

Indian comparison on karma/duhkha → qualified verdict

10 marks: one problem + one response + evaluation

15 marks: logical/evidential distinction + two responses

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- DEFINE God-concept + evil type → separate logical/evidential/existential demand
- formal argument → strongest defence/theodicy → hard-case objection
- Indian comparison on karma/duhkha → qualified verdict

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- 10 marks: one problem + one response + evaluation
- 15 marks: logical/evidential distinction + two responses
- 20 marks: Western and Indian matrix + hard cases + concept revision

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- CLOSE: evil may not disprove every God-concept, but it severely tests classical omni-God belief and forces costs in
- freedom, providence, power, afterlife or human understanding.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A complete answer identifies the challenged divine profile, reconstructs the relevant argument and grants each response only the conclusion it actually establishes.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT ADVANCED-DOSSIER RECONCILIATION — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED] ADVANCED SEMINAR MODULES - FROM COMPETENT TO EXAMINER-GRADE THE SECTION DOSSIER MARKS SKEPTICAL THEISM AND HORRENDOUS EVILS TEACHES CORNEA, REPRESENTATIVENESS, BALANCING-OFF VERSUS DEFEAT, AND GOODNESS-TO-PERSONS. THEIR OPTIONAL RESIDUE IS SECOND-ORDER WHETHER A POSITIVE THEODICY CAN BE COMBINED CONSISTENTLY WITH DEFEAT WITHIN A SUFFERER'S LIFE IS STILL A GENERAL

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- Advanced-dossier reconciliation — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- Advanced Seminar Modules - From Competent to Examiner-Grade
- The section dossier marks skeptical theism and horrendous evils as promoted to core because the owner source now
- teaches CORNEA, representativeness, balancing-off versus defeat, and goodness-to-persons.

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- Their optional residue is second-order: whether a positive theodicy can be combined consistently with global skepticism, and whether
- defeat within a sufferer's life is still a general theodicy.
- Free-will treatment of natural evil and victim-blaming critiques of karma remain high-value comparative refinements, not stand-alone catalogues.
- Modal logic without notation overload ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM High-value transition: The logical problem is

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- a question about whether the relevant propositions can be true.
- [THESIS] The logical problem is a question about whether the relevant propositions can be true together in at least one possible world.
- [ARGUMENT] Three modal ideas must be kept separate.
- First, logical possibility means that a description contains no contradiction.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.